

Advanced Viva Insights — Collaboration Analysis Guide

Using the Advanced Analysis Workbench for Workplace Collaboration Patterns Beyond Copilot

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1. Purpose

This guide covers using Viva Insights Advanced Analysis to understand workplace collaboration patterns **beyond Copilot**. The same analyst workbench, governed organizational data, the same privacy settings, and the same Power BI workflow — but with different metrics and templates focused on meetings, focus time, wellbeing, and manager effectiveness.

Collaboration analysis provides the organisational context that makes Copilot impact data meaningful. Without understanding baseline collaboration patterns, it is impossible to measure whether Copilot is genuinely improving how people work.

2. Relationship to Copilot Analytics

Collaboration analysis and Copilot analytics share the same infrastructure. Understanding their relationship helps analysts maximise both capabilities.

Aspect	Copilot Analytics	Collaboration Analysis
Role required	Insights Analyst	Insights Analyst (same role)
Org data	Attributes shared with Copilot Dashboard and Viva Insights	Uses the Viva Insights organizational dataset and partition configuration; verify the selected apps, current source, and attribute access
Privacy settings	Shared privacy configuration	Same privacy settings apply
Partitions	Configured per agency/BU	Same partitions carry over
Metrics focus	Copilot adoption, usage, impact, sentiment	Collaboration time, meeting patterns, focus time, after-hours, wellbeing
Data retention	Up to 13 months	Up to 27 months
Power BI workflow	Download .pbit → paste IDs → Load	Same workflow
Can run simultaneously	Yes — no conflict. Both query types can be active concurrently.	

Key Insight: Existing Viva Insights organizational data, partitions, and privacy settings can be reused, but first verify that the tenant’s current data source is healthy, the analyst is assigned to the intended partition, and the requested report is supported in the tenant cloud.

Sources: Use your organizational data in Microsoft 365 and Microsoft Viva (Microsoft Learn, updated 1 September 2026); Partitions in Viva Insights (14 September 2026); and Supported Microsoft 365 environments for Viva Insights features (30 September 2026).

3. Available Collaboration Templates

Viva Insights provides pre-built Power BI templates for common collaboration analysis scenarios. Each template includes predefined metrics, visualisations, and narrative guidance.

Template	Analysis Focus	Key Questions Answered	GCC Availability
Ways of Working	Collaboration patterns, meeting effectiveness, wellbeing, coaching	How much time do employees spend in digital collaboration? Is meeting time effective? Do employees get sufficient focus time? Are managers coaching their teams?	Supported
Meeting Effectiveness	Meeting culture — duration, frequency, overlap, multitasking	Are meetings too long? Too frequent? Do employees multitask during meetings? How much time is spent in recurring vs. ad-hoc meetings?	Supported
Wellbeing – Balance & Flexibility	Focus time, work-life balance, urgency, flexible schedules, breaks, community	Are employees working after hours? Do they have enough focus time? Are schedules flexible? Do employees take breaks and connect with colleagues?	Supported
Impact Explorer	Impact estimation of Viva Insights actions	Did meeting reduction initiatives save time? Did focus time protection improve productivity? What is the estimated impact of behavioural nudges?	Supported
Manager Effectiveness	Manager 1:1 time, team collaboration, span of control	Are managers spending enough 1:1 time with direct reports? What is the typical span of control? How do team collaboration patterns vary by manager?	Supported in GCC Moderate; partial in GCC High

Template	Analysis Focus	Key Questions Answered	GCC Availability
External Collaboration	Collaboration with external contacts — meetings, email, chat	How much time is spent collaborating with external parties? Which teams have the most external interaction? What channels are used?	Not listed as supported

Environment gate: Microsoft’s Supported environments matrix lists availability feature by feature for GCC Moderate (GCC-M) and GCC High (GCC-H). The Agent Dashboard, Copilot Dashboard metric export, the Consumption Dashboard and the Copilot Dashboard Readiness page are not available in either. Delegate access to dashboards is not available in GCC-M and is partial in GCC-H. Of the Copilot Power BI templates, only the Copilot business impact report is supported (GCC-M: yes; GCC-H: partial). For the behavioural templates in this guide, GCC-M lists Business resilience, Change management, Growth, inclusion and engagement, Hybrid workforce experience, Impact explorer, Learning culture, Manager effectiveness, Meeting effectiveness, Onboarding and development, Recurring meeting audit, Ways of working, and Wellbeing – Balance and flexibility as supported. GCC-H lists Business resilience, Impact explorer, Meeting effectiveness, Recurring meeting audit, Ways of working and Wellbeing – Balance and flexibility as supported; Growth, inclusion and engagement, Hybrid workforce experience, Manager effectiveness and Onboarding and development as partial; and Change management and Learning culture as not supported. Publish reports is partial in GCC-H. Custom person, meeting and cross-collaboration queries are supported in both. The matrix has no DoD column, so do not infer DoD availability. Check the matrix for each feature before planning a government-cloud rollout, and validate the exact cloud and live tenant UI before committing to a template. **Source:** Supported Microsoft 365 environments for Viva Insights features (Microsoft Learn, updated 30 September 2026).

Template References

- Ways of Working
- Meeting Effectiveness
- Wellbeing – Balance & Flexibility
- Impact Explorer
- Manager Effectiveness
- External Collaboration

4. Key Behavioural Metrics

The following table groups the core behavioural metrics available for collaboration analysis. These metrics can be used in templates, custom queries, and filters.

Category	Metrics
Meeting Hours	Meeting hours, recurring meeting hours, conflicting meeting hours, multitasking hours, 60 minutes or longer meeting hours, large and long meeting hours
Focus Time	Available-to-focus hours, uninterrupted hours, booked focus hours (and booked focus hours kept with plan)
After-Hours	After-hours collaboration hours, after-hours meeting hours, after-hours email hours, after-hours chat hours
Email	Email hours, emails sent
Chat & Calls	Chat hours, chats sent, call hours, calls
Manager Interaction	Meeting and call hours with manager 1:1, meeting and call hours with manager
Collaboration Scope	Collaboration hours, external collaboration hours, internal network size, external network size

Metric Tip: "Multitasking meeting hours" captures time in meetings where the employee was also actively sending emails or chats — a strong indicator of meeting overload or low meeting relevance.

Reference: Viva Insights Metric Definitions

5. Custom Query Capabilities

Beyond the pre-built templates, analysts can create fully custom queries with tailored metrics, filters, and groupings.

Custom Metric Features

- Filter metrics by day of week (e.g., meeting hours on Fridays only)
- Filter by meeting duration (e.g., meetings longer than 60 minutes)
- Filter by attendee count (e.g., meetings with more than 10 attendees)
- Filter by organisational attributes from org data (e.g., department, location, level)
- Clone existing metrics and modify filters for tailored analysis

Copilot Assistant

The Viva Insights analyst workbench includes a Copilot assistant that can help you choose appropriate metrics and filters based on your analysis goals. Describe what you want to measure, and the assistant will suggest relevant metrics and configurations.

Power User Tip: Clone a standard metric (e.g., "Meeting hours"), then add a filter for "recurring = true" and "duration > 60 minutes" to create a metric that specifically captures time in long recurring meetings — a common target for optimisation.

Reference: Custom Metrics in Viva Insights

6. Prerequisites

The prerequisites for collaboration analysis are the same as for Copilot Analytics. If you have already set up the Copilot Analytics environment, no additional configuration is required.

Requirement	Details
Role	Insights Analyst role assigned independently in the Microsoft 365 admin center, plus access to the intended partition
Licences	50+ Viva Insights licences for Advanced Analytics (included with Microsoft 365 Copilot licence). Note: the Copilot Dashboard itself requires only 1+ Copilot licences.
Power BI Desktop	December 2022 release or later
Org Data	Confirm the current source and selected downstream apps in the tenant. For add/edit imports, Message Center and the live tenant UI control whether Microsoft 365 Organizational Data Service (formerly Organizational Data in Microsoft 365) or a tenant-enabled Viva path applies; do not infer the path from a date.

Requirement	Details
Behavioural Insights	Enabled through the “Behavioral insights” control in Viva feature access management (VFAM) in the Microsoft 365 admin center (when turning it on, also select Advanced Analysis), or with PowerShell (FeatureId BehavioralInsights). This is a tenant-level setting that an AI Administrator or Viva Insights Administrator can enable. It is off by default for new customers after 15 November 2025 (for earlier customers it is off if no analyst has been assigned since May 2025 or no analyst has created or published reports or queries in advanced analysis), and it takes about five days to process after it is enabled. Microsoft’s feature access management article states that its access controls aren’t available in GCC High or DoD; for GCC, check the documentation for the specific app.

Current-state sources: Upload and maintain data through the Microsoft 365 admin center (Microsoft Learn, updated 13 August 2026) says migration timing is tenant-specific and communicated in Message Center; Use Microsoft Entra plus .csv files for parallel data uploads (Last updated 7 July 2026) says add/edit uploads are no longer supported in the Viva web app; Manage settings for the Microsoft Copilot Dashboard, Agent Dashboard, Consumption Dashboard, and Viva Insights web app (13 August 2026) still recommends that path for Viva Insights customers. If Message Center and UI conflict, stop and escalate rather than choosing an article silently.

Analyst data handling: Insights Analysts can access de-identified individual-level organizational and Microsoft 365 metrics. Encrypted person identifiers reduce direct identification, but title, location, organization, or custom attributes can enable inference. Assign least-privilege partitions, require privacy/security training, document the approved analysis purpose, govern downloaded CSV/PBI output as potentially personal data, and review the audit log of analyst-authored queries. **Sources:** Roles in Viva Insights — Levels of responsibility (Microsoft Learn, updated 7 July 2026) and Advanced analysis privacy — Advanced analysis access (10 December 2025).

Note: With behavioural insights switched off, Copilot metrics remain available, but behavioural metrics (meeting hours, focus time, etc.) and the meeting, cross-collaboration and external collaboration queries do not. Behavioural insights are off by default for new customers, so check this setting first; processing takes about five days after you enable them.

7. How to Create a Collaboration Report

The workflow for creating a collaboration report follows the same pattern as Copilot Analytics templates. If you have created a Copilot query before, this process will be familiar.

- 1 Sign in to `analysis.insights.cloud.microsoft` with your Insights Analyst account.
- 2 Select **Create analysis** from the left navigation, then choose **Templates**.
- 3 Select a collaboration template — for example, **Ways of Working**.
- 4 Configure the query:
 - 5 **Name:** Give it a descriptive name (e.g., "Q1 2026 Ways of Working – All Agencies")
 - 6 **Time period:** Select the analysis window — collaboration data supports up to 27 months
 - 7 **Auto-refresh:** Enable if you want the query to re-run automatically on a schedule
- 8 Review the predefined metrics included in the template. Optionally add custom metrics using the **Add metric** button.
- 9 Set employee filters to scope the analysis (e.g., specific departments, locations, or levels). Select which org attributes to include in the output for grouping.
- 10 Select **Run** to execute the query. Processing time depends on population size and time period — Microsoft says a template query might take a few minutes to run; larger populations and longer periods can take longer.
- 11 Once complete, download the **.pbit** file (Power BI template) from the query results page.
- 12 Open the .pbit file in Power BI Desktop. When prompted, paste the **Partition ID** and **Query ID** from the Viva Insights results page. Select **Load**.
- 13 Explore the report — navigate through the pre-built pages, apply filters, and customise visualisations as needed.
- 14 To share with leadership, use the **Publish Reports** feature in Viva Insights to push a read-only version to authorised viewers, only when that report is supported in the tenant cloud.

Time-Saver: If you have an existing Copilot query with org attributes and filters configured, you can use the same setup for your collaboration query — just select a different template. No need to reconfigure org data or privacy settings.

8. Common Use Cases

Scenario 1: Meeting Culture Audit

Template: Meeting Effectiveness

Goal: Identify meeting overload, long recurring meetings, and multitasking patterns across the organisation.

Approach:

1. Run the Meeting Effectiveness template with a 6-month time window.
2. Analyse metrics: recurring meeting hours, meetings > 60 minutes, multitasking hours.
3. Group by department or business unit to identify hotspots.
4. Calculate potential time savings: if average employee spends 4 hours/week in meetings that could be emails, that's X hours reclaimed per person per week.

Outcome: Data-driven recommendations to reclaim meeting time, backed by actual behavioural data rather than surveys.

Scenario 2: Wellbeing Baseline Before Copilot Rollout

Template: Wellbeing – Balance & Flexibility

Goal: Capture focus time, after-hours work, and work-life balance metrics **before** Copilot deployment. Then compare after 3 months using the Copilot Impact template.

Approach:

1. Run the Wellbeing template covering the 4 weeks immediately before Copilot licence assignment. Record the baseline period and cohort before comparing post-deployment results; see the Analyst Playbook: Business Impact setup and interpretation.
2. Record baseline metrics: average focus hours, after-hours collaboration hours, weekend work hours.
3. After 3 months of Copilot usage, run the Copilot Impact template for the same population.
4. Compare pre- and post-deployment metrics to quantify Copilot's impact on employee wellbeing.

Outcome: Quantifiable evidence of whether Copilot improved, maintained, or negatively affected employee wellbeing metrics.

Scenario 3: Manager Effectiveness Programme

Template: Manager Effectiveness

Goal: Identify managers with low 1:1 time or high span of control. Feed insights into leadership development initiatives.

Approach:

1. Run the Manager Effectiveness template for the past 6 months.
2. Analyse metrics: manager 1:1 meeting hours, team size (span of control), team after-hours patterns.
3. Filter to managers with fewer than 30 minutes of 1:1 time per direct report per month.
4. Cross-reference with team wellbeing metrics to identify teams with both low manager engagement and high after-hours work.

Outcome: Targeted list of managers who would benefit from coaching programmes, with behavioural evidence to support the recommendation.

9. Data Retention

Understanding data retention windows is important for planning analysis timeframes and comparing historical trends.

Data Type	Maximum Retention	Notes
Collaboration metrics (meetings, email, chat, focus time)	Up to 27 months	Initially 13 months, then grows through weekly refreshes to a maximum of 27 months. No collaboration data older than 27 months is retained.
Copilot metrics (adoption, usage, impact, sentiment)	Up to 13 months	Viva Insights retains Microsoft 365 Copilot metrics for no more than 13 months.

Practical Implication: Collaboration analysis can look further back in history than Copilot analysis. This means you can establish a rich historical baseline of collaboration patterns — even if Copilot was deployed recently. Use the longer retention window to identify seasonal trends, reorganisation impacts, and long-term cultural shifts.

Source: Advanced analysis privacy — Data retention for active tenants (Microsoft Learn, updated 10 December 2025).

10. Operational Validation

Cadence	Check	Pass / escalation rule
Before each new analysis	Confirm tenant cloud, template availability, analyst role/partition, current org–data source, privacy threshold, and approved purpose.	Proceed only when each dependency is evidenced. Stop if Message Center and UI disagree.
After an org–data or partition change	Rerun a known query; compare population, key attributes, suppression, and partition scope with the pre–change baseline.	Pass when counts and scope reconcile. Roll back/correct the data or partition and preserve logs if they do not.
Monthly	Review Message Center and Microsoft 365 Service Health for Viva Insights changes/incidents; check query failures, data freshness, and auto–refresh status.	Record notice/incident IDs and dates. Do not diagnose a tenant defect until current service and rollout notices are excluded.
Quarterly	Review analyst assignments, partitions, query audit logs, exported report locations, retention, and the supported–environments matrix.	Remove unnecessary access/copies. Escalate undocumented product behavior with query ID, partition ID, UTC time, cloud, expected/actual counts, and screenshots.

Sources: Advanced analysis privacy — Advanced analysis access and query logging (Microsoft Learn, updated 10 December 2025); organizational–data migration notices are documented in Upload and maintain data through the Microsoft 365 admin center (13 August 2026).

11. References

Topic	URL
Ways of Working Template	learn.microsoft.com/viva/insights/advanced/analyst/templates/ways-of-working
Meeting Effectiveness Template	learn.microsoft.com/viva/insights/advanced/analyst/templates/meeting-effectiveness
Wellbeing – Balance & Flexibility Template	learn.microsoft.com/viva/insights/advanced/analyst/templates/wellbeing
Impact Explorer Template	learn.microsoft.com/viva/insights/advanced/analyst/templates/impact-explorer

Topic	URL
Manager Effectiveness Template	learn.microsoft.com/viva/insights/advanced/analyst/templates/manager-effectiveness
External Collaboration	learn.microsoft.com/viva/insights/advanced/analyst/external-collaboration
Metric Definitions	learn.microsoft.com/viva/insights/advanced/reference/metrics
Custom Metrics	learn.microsoft.com/viva/insights/advanced/analyst/custom-metrics

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